# CareEcho: Hack Knight Build Plan

Oct 9, 2026 · @Daniel Lin

## The project in one minute

CareEcho is an AI companion for people with dementia that answers the same question as many times as it's asked, calmly and correctly, using only memories a caregiver has confirmed. We demo it Sunday at 12:30 PM, with the full demo path working by Saturday noon.

### What it does

- **Caregiver adds memories by talking.** During a listening session the caregiver speaks naturally ("Your dentist appointment is tomorrow at three, Anna picks you up at two thirty"). CareEcho extracts the plan, and the caregiver confirms it with one tap.
- **Patient asks, again and again.** The patient talks to a warm, neutral AI voice that answers from confirmed memories. The answer is the same and just as patient the sixth time.
- **Memories stay honest.** Every memory records its source, time, and status. Tentative plans are said as tentative. Updates replace old versions. What the patient reports ("I took my pill") stays self-reported.
- **Family voice only for family words.** A confirmed message from Anna plays in Anna's cloned voice, with her consent. The live conversation never uses her voice.
- **Caregiver insight.** A dashboard shows what the patient keeps asking about, open questions, and alerts.

### Scope

| Level | Features | Done by |
|---|---|---|
| MVP | Caregiver session, extraction, confirm, patient Q and A, updates replace old plans | Saturday 12 PM |
| Full demo | Tentative plans, missing information alert, self-reported meds, repetition dashboard, family voice messages, life story search | Saturday 6 PM |

| Level | Features | Done by |
|---|---|---|
| Stretch | Presage agitation detection, deployed public site | Saturday 11 PM, only if Full demo is solid |

### Tracks we enter

Health (main theme), Best Use of ElevenLabs, Best Use of Gemini API, Best Use of Tiger Data, Best Use of Snowflake API, Best Domain Name from GoDaddy Registry, plus Presage if the stretch lands. Best Overall and Runner Up are judged on every project automatically.

## Prep: decide and set up by 5 PM Friday

Spend the first 75 minutes on these decisions and accounts, then split up. Every default below is a recommendation; change any of them now, not on Saturday.

### Decisions

| Decision | Recommended default | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| Voice policy | Neutral warm voice for conversation; cloned voice only for confirmed family messages; caregiver can turn it off | Avoids the deception question judges will lead with |
| Whose voice gets cloned | A teammate, with recorded consent, playing "Anna" | Never clone anyone who hasn't agreed |
| Demo characters | Patient Rose, daughter Anna, caregiver is Anna or a home aide | Everyone rehearses the same story |
| Caregiver input | Caregiver app on its own device: hold to talk, or type | Only caregiver input can create a confirmable memory, so no speaker identification needed |
| Patient interface | A browser page in kiosk style on a second laptop: one big talk button, today's date, next event in large text | Simple for the patient, clear for judges |

| Decision | Recommended default | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| Stack | React with Vite (TypeScript), FastAPI (Python), Tiger Cloud Postgres, Gemini, ElevenLabs, Snowflake | Everyone knows it; Tiger Data is the main database |
| Agent tools | ElevenLabs client tools (run in the browser and call our backend) | Avoids exposing a local server to the internet for webhooks |
| Timezone | America/New_York for resolving "tomorrow" and "at three" | Relative times must become exact dates at capture |
| Hosting for judging | Run locally on our laptops; domain points to a landing page with the Devpost and repo links | Venue Wi-Fi can't break a local demo |
| Domain name | Pick 3 options now and check them with the MLH GoDaddy code | The domain prize is judged on the name |
| Repo layout | One repo: frontend/, backend/, docs/; short-lived branches, merge to main often | Rule: repo created after noon Friday, all code pushed before noon Sunday |

## Accounts and setup checklist

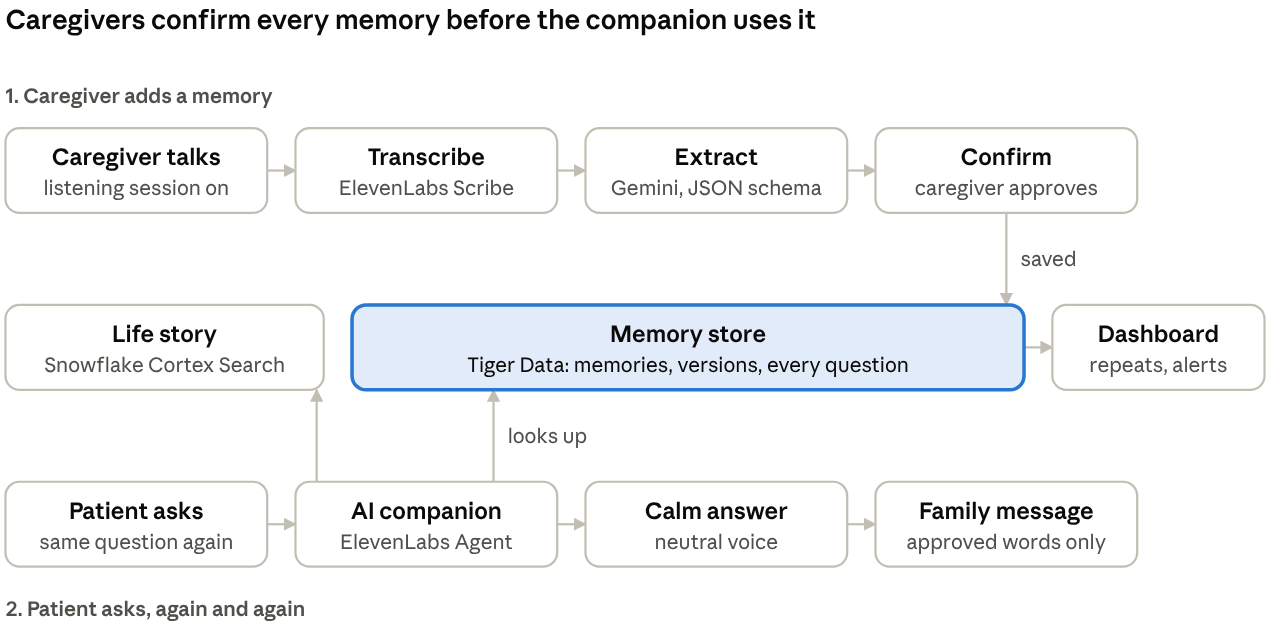
- [ ] GitHub repo created (after 12 PM Friday) with all three members added
- [ ] Gemini API key from Google AI Studio
- [ ] ElevenLabs account; claim the MLH perk; confirm Instant Voice Cloning is included in the plan
- [ ] Record 1 to 2 minutes of the "Anna" teammate reading naturally, in a quiet spot, and clone it
- [ ] Tiger Cloud service created; connection string shared privately (not in the repo)
- [ ] Snowflake 120 day student trial; a warehouse and database created
- [ ] GoDaddy Registry domain code claimed on MLH
- [ ] Shared .env.example in the repo listing every key name, with the real .env never committed
- [ ] Devpost project created and all three members joined
- [ ] Presage API key (only needed for the stretch, but takes two minutes)

### Contracts to agree on before splitting

- The memory JSON shape (section "Memory rules and data model")
- The backend endpoints and agent tool names (section "Who does what")
- The demo script (section "Demo script"), so every feature built serves a step in it

## Architecture

Two lanes meet at one memory store: the caregiver adds memories at the top, and the patient asks questions at the bottom. The companion can only say what the store holds.




CareEcho architecture · capture lane and answer lane

The top lane is the only way a memory enters, and it always ends with a caregiver approval. The bottom lane only reads, which is why the companion cannot invent plans.

| Component | Built with | Job | Owner |
|---|---|---|---|
| Caregiver app | React | Listening sessions, confirmation cards, memory history, dashboard | Interface |
| Patient page | React plus ElevenLabs React SDK | Talk button, today's plan in large text, family messages | Interface and Voice |

| Component | Built with | Job | Owner |
|---|---|---|---|
| Backend | FastAPI | Endpoints for memories, alerts, interactions, family messages | Memory |
| Transcription | ElevenLabs Speech to Text (Scribe) | Caregiver speech to text | Voice |
| Extraction | Gemini structured output | Text to dated, typed memory candidates and updates | Memory |
| Memory store | Tiger Data (Postgres plus TimescaleDB) | Memories, version chains, interactions hypertable, hourly aggregate | Memory |
| Life story | Snowflake Cortex Search | Answers about Rose's past and preferences | Memory |
| Companion | ElevenLabs Agent with client tools | Patient conversation in a neutral voice | Voice |
| Family voice | ElevenLabs Instant Voice Cloning plus text to speech | Approved messages in Anna's voice | Voice |

## Memory rules and data model

The companion only ever speaks from memories in the database, so these rules are what make CareEcho trustworthy. They are also the strongest part of the pitch.

### Rules

1. Only the caregiver role can confirm a memory. Extraction creates a **pending** memory; nothing pending is ever spoken.
2. Relative times are resolved to exact timestamps at capture, in America/New_York, and the caregiver sees the resolved time before confirming.
3. An update never edits in place. It creates a new memory that **supersedes** the old one, and the agent only sees current versions. The caregiver sees the history.
4. **Tentative** memories ("might," "probably," "we'll see") are spoken as tentative: "Anna said she might visit Saturday."

5. Patient statements are stored as **self-reported**, never as facts. "I took my pill" is logged and shown to the caregiver, and never repeated to anyone as verified.
6. The agent never invents promises, intentions, or feelings for a family member. If the answer isn't in memory, it says it isn't sure and raises a caregiver alert.
7. Past events expire automatically. A dentist appointment stops being mentioned after it ends.

## Memory statuses

| Status | Meaning | Spoken to patient? |
|---|---|---|
| pending | Extracted, waiting for caregiver review | No |
| confirmed | Approved by the caregiver | Yes |
| tentative | Approved, but the plan itself is uncertain | Yes, with uncertain wording |
| superseded | Replaced by a newer version | No |
| rejected | Caregiver said it was wrong | No |
| self_reported | Said by the patient | Never as fact |

## Tables in Tiger Data

```
-- Regular table: one row per memory version
CREATE TABLE memories (
  id UUID PRIMARY KEY,
  patient_id TEXT NOT NULL,
  kind TEXT NOT NULL,            -- appointment, plan, routine, preference,
medication, person
  summary TEXT NOT NULL,         -- 'Dentist appointment'
  details JSONB,                 -- {"who": "Anna", "pickup_at": "...",
"place": "..."}
  event_at TIMESTAMPTZ,          -- resolved exact time, if any
  expires_at TIMESTAMPTZ,
  status TEXT NOT NULL,          -- pending, confirmed, tentative,
superseded, rejected, self_reported
  source TEXT NOT NULL,          -- caregiver_session, caregiver_typed,
patient
  source_quote TEXT,             -- exact words it came from
  supersedes_id UUID REFERENCES memories(id),
```

```
  created_at TIMESTAMPTZ DEFAULT now(),
  confirmed_at TIMESTAMPTZ
);

-- Hypertable: one row per patient question
CREATE TABLE interactions (
  ts TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL,
  patient_id TEXT NOT NULL,
  topic TEXT,                    -- 'pickup time', 'Anna visit'
  question TEXT,
  answer TEXT,
  memory_ids UUID[],
  answered BOOLEAN,
  latency_ms INT
);
SELECT create_hypertable('interactions', 'ts');

-- Continuous aggregate: questions per topic per hour, powers the dashboard
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW questions_hourly
WITH (timescaledb.continuous) AS
SELECT time_bucket('1 hour', ts) AS hour, patient_id, topic, count(*) AS asks
FROM interactions GROUP BY hour, patient_id, topic;

-- Alerts for the caregiver
CREATE TABLE alerts (
  id UUID PRIMARY KEY, ts TIMESTAMPTZ DEFAULT now(), patient_id TEXT,
  kind TEXT,                     -- missing_info, self_reported_med,
help_requested
  message TEXT, resolved BOOLEAN DEFAULT false
);
```

## What Gemini returns from a caregiver transcript

Use Gemini's structured output with this shape. Pass in the current time, the timezone, and the patient's current confirmed memories so it can mark updates.

```
{
  "candidates": [
    {
      "kind": "appointment",
      "summary": "Dentist appointment",
      "details": {"who": "Anna", "pickup_at": "2026-10-10T14:30:00-04:00"},
      "event_at": "2026-10-10T15:00:00-04:00",
      "certainty": "definite",
      "updates_memory_id": null,
      "source_quote": "Your dentist appointment is tomorrow at three. Anna
will pick you up at two thirty."
    }
  ]
}
```

## Agent tools (ElevenLabs client tools)

| Tool | Called when | Returns |
|---|---|---|
| get_memories(topic) | Any question about plans, people, routines | Current confirmed and tentative memories for that topic |
| search_life_story(query) | Questions about the past, family, preferences | Top passages from Snowflake Cortex Search |
| log_patient_statement(text, kind) | Patient reports something (“I took my pill”) | Saved as self_reported |
| ask_caregiver(question) | The answer isn’t in memory | Creates a missing_info alert |
| log_interaction(topic, question, answer) | After every answer | Row in interactions |

### Agent system prompt (starting point)

```
You are CareEcho, a calm, warm AI companion for Rose, who has memory loss.
- You are an AI companion. If asked who you are, say so kindly.
- Answer only from get_memories and search_life_story. Never guess.
- Keep answers to one or two short sentences. Use exact times and names.
- If Rose asks the same thing again, answer the same way, just as warmly.
Never say "I already told you."
- Tentative memories: say they are not certain yet.
- If the answer is missing, say you are not sure and that you will ask Anna.
Call ask_caregiver.
- Never promise anything on behalf of family, and never describe their
feelings or intentions.
- If Rose says she did something (took medicine, ate), thank her and call
log_patient_statement.
- After every answer, call log_interaction.
```

## Who does what

Three owners, each with a clear lane, connected by the endpoints and tools listed below. Everyone builds against mock data first, so nobody waits on anyone Friday night.

### Voice owner

Owns everything the patient hears and everything spoken into the system.

- ElevenLabs Agent: neutral voice, system prompt, client tools wired to the backend
- Patient page conversation component using the ElevenLabs React SDK
- Caregiver listening session: record audio, transcribe with ElevenLabs Speech to Text (Scribe), send the transcript to the backend
- Cloned "Anna" voice and the family message endpoint (text to speech in the cloned voice)
- Conversation test script: 15 patient questions including repeats, a missing answer, a medication report, and "are you Anna?"
- Latency tuning: short answers, fast tool calls

### Memory owner

Owns what CareEcho knows and whether it is right.

- Tiger Data schema, hypertable, continuous aggregate (from the data model section)
- Gemini extraction: prompt, structured output, time resolution, update detection
- Memory endpoints: create pending, confirm, reject, supersede, list current, history
- Snowflake: a life story document for Rose loaded into a Cortex Search service, and the search endpoint
- Alerts and interaction logging
- An extraction test set of 20 caregiver sentences ("next Tuesday," "in two hours," "might," "change pickup to two") with expected outputs

### Interface owner

Owns what judges see and everything that gets submitted.

- Caregiver app: listening session button, confirmation cards showing the resolved time and the source quote, memory list with version history, alerts feed
- Dashboard: repeated questions per hour (from the continuous aggregate), open alerts, self-reported items
- Patient page shell: big talk button, today's date, next event in large text, family message playback
- Backend glue and API client, seed data, demo reset button
- Domain, landing page, README, Devpost, demo video, the architecture sheet for the table

## Endpoints (FastAPI)

| Method and path | Owner | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| POST /sessions/transcript | Memory | Takes transcript text, returns pending candidates |
| POST /memories/{id}/confirm | Memory | Confirms, or saves an edited version, and supersedes if needed |
| POST /memories/{id}/reject | Memory | Rejects a candidate |
| GET /memories/current?topic= | Memory | What the agent may say |
| GET /memories/{id}/history | Memory | Version chain for the caregiver |

| Method and path | Owner | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| GET /life-story?q= | Memory | Snowflake Cortex Search results |
| POST /patient/statements | Memory | Self-reported statements |
| POST /alerts | Memory | Missing information and other alerts |
| POST /interactions | Memory | One row per answer |
| GET /dashboard | Memory | Hourly asks per topic, open alerts |
| POST /family-message | Voice | Text in, audio in Anna's cloned voice out |
| POST /demo/reset | Interface | Clears and reseeds the demo patient |

### Handoffs

- **Friday 6 PM:** the Memory owner publishes mock responses for every endpoint, so Voice and Interface can build against them.
- **Friday 9 PM:** real endpoints replace the mocks.
- **Every 3 hours:** a 10 minute standup. What works, what's blocked, what's next.

## Schedule and checkpoints

The MVP must work end to end by Saturday 12 PM and the full demo by Saturday 6 PM. Everything after that is polish, stretch, and rehearsal. If a checkpoint is missed, cut scope instead of pushing the next one.

### Friday 3:45 to 5:00 PM: prep (everyone)

- [ ] All decisions in the prep section agreed
- [ ] Accounts created, keys in each person's local .env
- [ ] Repo scaffolded: frontend (Vite React TS), backend (FastAPI), docs
- [ ] "Anna" voice recorded and cloned

### Friday 5:00 to 9:00 PM: skeletons

- [ ] **Voice:** an agent that talks in the browser and calls one client tool returning a hardcoded memory

- [ ] **Memory:** schema live in Tiger Data; Gemini extracts the dentist sentence into correct JSON; mock endpoints published by 6 PM
- [ ] **Interface:** caregiver app and patient page shells with routing, calling the mock endpoints

**Checkpoint 1, 9 PM:** a typed caregiver sentence becomes a pending card, gets confirmed, and the agent answers "when is my dentist appointment?" from the database.

## Friday 9 PM to 2 AM: core loop

- [ ] **Voice:** caregiver hold-to-talk with Scribe transcription; all five client tools wired to real endpoints
- [ ] **Memory:** confirm, reject, supersede, and current list working; time resolution passes the test set
- [ ] **Interface:** confirmation cards show the resolved time and source quote; memory list with history

Sleep in shifts. Each person gets at least 5 hours between 2 AM and 9 AM.

## Saturday 9 AM to 12 PM: MVP

- [ ] Demo steps 1 to 4 run end to end, twice in a row, without touching code
- [ ] Demo reset button works

**Checkpoint 2, 12 PM:** the MVP demo works. If not, the afternoon goes to fixing it, and the full demo features shrink.

## Saturday 12 to 6 PM: full demo

- [ ] **Voice:** family messages in the cloned voice; tentative wording; missing information response; medication report handling
- [ ] **Memory:** Snowflake life story search; alerts; interaction logging and the continuous aggregate
- [ ] **Interface:** dashboard with repetitions per hour, alerts, and self-reported items; patient page polish (large text, high contrast)
- [ ] Short checkpoint at 3 PM: what's at risk?

**Checkpoint 3, 6 PM:** the full demo script runs end to end. Feature freeze on the demo path.

### Saturday 6 to 11 PM: polish and stretch

- [ ] Record the backup demo video by 9 PM (2 minutes, clean audio)
- [ ] Domain live with the landing page
- [ ] README and Devpost draft written
- [ ] Stretch, only if checkpoint 3 passed: Presage agitation detection triggering a calming message and an alert
- [ ] First full pitch run through, timed

### Saturday night

Sleep. A rested demo beats a feature built at 4 AM.

### Sunday 8:00 to 11:45 AM: finish

- [ ] Bug fixes only, no new features
- [ ] Rehearse the pitch at least 8 times, swapping who presents each part
- [ ] Rehearse the hard judge questions
- [ ] Devpost final: video, repo, domain, every track selected
- [ ] Final commit pushed by 11:45 AM (anything pushed after 12 PM disqualifies the project)

### Sunday 12:00 to 12:30 PM: set up the table

- [ ] Both laptops charged, demo reset, speaker and headset tested
- [ ] Architecture sheet printed or on a second screen
- [ ] Backup video open in a tab

## Demo script

The live demo runs about 90 seconds on two laptops: the caregiver app on one, Rose's patient page on the other. One teammate plays Anna (the caregiver), one plays Rose, and one narrates to the judge.

### Setup before each judge

- [ ] Press demo reset: Rose's profile, life story, and a seeded week of questions loaded
- [ ] Patient page shows today's date and "No plans yet today"

- [ ] Dashboard open on the caregiver laptop

## Core steps (MVP)

1. **Caregiver adds a plan.** Anna holds the talk button: "Mom, your dentist appointment is tomorrow at three. I'll pick you up at two thirty." A pending card appears with the date and times resolved and the quote underneath. Narrator: "Nothing is used until a caregiver approves it."
2. **Caregiver confirms.** Anna taps confirm. The patient page updates to "Tomorrow: Dentist, 3:00 PM."
3. **Rose asks, then asks again.** Rose: "When am I leaving tomorrow?" CareEcho: "Anna is picking you up at two thirty tomorrow for your dentist appointment." Rose asks again with different words. Same answer, same warmth. Narrator: "The sixth time sounds exactly like the first."
4. **The plan changes.** Anna: "Actually, I'll pick her up at two instead." The card shows it replacing the old time. Rose asks again: "Anna is picking you up at two tomorrow."

## Extra moments (full demo, pick 2 based on time)

5. **Tentative.** Anna: "I might come by Saturday." Rose: "Is Anna visiting this weekend?" CareEcho: "Anna said she might come by Saturday. It isn't certain yet."
6. **Missing information.** Rose: "Is Anna bringing the dog?" CareEcho: "I'm not sure. I'll ask Anna for you." An alert pops up on the caregiver laptop.
7. **Self-reported medication.** Rose: "I already took my pills." The dashboard shows it marked self-reported, not verified.
8. **Family message.** Anna's confirmed message plays on the speaker in her cloned voice: "Hi Mom, it's Anna. I'll see you at two tomorrow."

## Close (15 seconds)

Show the dashboard: "Rose asked about her pickup time 7 times this afternoon." Narrator: "For a caregiver, that pattern is information. For Rose, every answer is patient and correct."

# Pitch and judge questions

Judging is science fair style, so expect two to three minutes per judge, scored on creativity, alignment with the track, and completeness. The pitch below fits in 2 minutes 30 seconds with the demo inside it.

## Pitch script

| Time | Who | What to say or do |
|---|---|---|
| 0:00 to 0:20 | Narrator | "People with dementia ask the same question again and again. 'When am I leaving?' Ten times an hour. Caregivers love them, and they're exhausted. CareEcho answers every time, patiently and correctly." |
| 0:20 to 1:50 | All three | Demo core steps 1 to 4, plus two extra moments |
| 1:50 to 2:15 | Memory owner | "The hard part isn't the voice, it's trust. Every memory has a source, a timestamp, and a status. Nothing is spoken until a caregiver confirms it. Updates replace old versions, and what the patient reports stays self-reported." Point at the architecture sheet. |
| 2:15 to 2:30 | Narrator | "Next: testing with caregivers, and a calm-down mode that senses agitation." |

## 20 second versions for sponsor judges

- **ElevenLabs:** four of their products in one flow: an Agent with client tools for the patient, Scribe to transcribe the caregiver, Instant Voice Cloning, and text to speech for approved family messages.
- **Gemini:** structured output turns messy speech into dated, typed memories, including spotting when a sentence updates an existing plan.
- **Tiger Data:** one Postgres database for relational memories and a hypertable of every question, with a continuous aggregate powering the repetition dashboard live.
- **Snowflake:** Cortex Search over Rose's life story, so CareEcho can talk about her past without guessing.
- **GoDaddy:** the domain name and the landing page.

## Questions judges may ask

| Question | Answer |
|---|---|
| Isn't it deceptive to use a family member's voice? | The conversation uses a neutral AI voice. Anna's voice only plays words Anna actually said or approved, with her consent, and the caregiver can turn it off. |
| What if the AI says something wrong? | It can only speak confirmed memories. If something is missing, it says it isn't sure and asks the caregiver. It never guesses. |
| What if extraction gets the time wrong? | The caregiver sees the resolved date and the original quote before confirming. Nothing pending is ever spoken. |
| Why not Alexa reminders? | Alexa repeats what you scheduled. It doesn't handle updates, uncertainty, self-reported facts, or tell the caregiver what the patient keeps asking. |
| Does the patient know it's an AI? | It says so whenever asked. We don't rely on the patient remembering that, which is why the family voice is never used live. |
| Privacy? | Listening only happens in sessions the caregiver starts. We store text and the memories, not ongoing audio. |
| Have you tested this with caregivers? | Be honest: not yet, and it's our next step. Bring any feedback you gathered on Saturday. |
| How would this make money? | A subscription for families or home care agencies, where repetition data also helps care planning. |

## Validation to gather Saturday (optional, high value)

Message 2 or 3 people who have cared for someone with dementia and ask: "Would this help? Would the family voice comfort or confuse?" One real quote in the pitch makes the problem concrete.

# Deliverables

Seven things must exist by 11:45 AM Sunday. The Interface owner tracks this list, and everyone writes their part.

## Submission checklist

- [ ] **Working demo** on two laptops, reset button tested
- [ ] **Public GitHub repo** with every commit made after 12 PM Friday and before 12 PM Sunday
- [ ] **README** (outline below)
- [ ] **Devpost submission** with all tracks selected (outline below)
- [ ] **Demo video,** about 2 minutes, uploaded to YouTube as unlisted and linked on Devpost
- [ ] **Domain** registered through GoDaddy Registry, pointing to the landing page
- [ ] **Architecture sheet:** one page with the diagram and the sponsor tools labeled, printed or on a second screen

## README outline

1. One line description and a screenshot
2. The problem, in three sentences
3. How it works, with the architecture diagram
4. Memory rules (the seven rules, short)
5. Tech stack and which sponsor tool does what
6. How to run it locally (.env keys, backend, frontend, demo reset)
7. Ethics and safety: consent for voice cloning, no live impersonation, caregiver confirmation
8. Team

## Devpost outline

| Section | What to write |
|---|---|
| Tagline | "A patient companion that answers the same question every time, from memories caregivers confirm." |

| Section | What to write |
|---|---|
| Inspiration | Repeated questions and caregiver exhaustion; why familiarity matters |
| What it does | Capture, confirm, answer, update, alert, dashboard |
| How we built it | One paragraph per sponsor tool, naming exactly what it does |
| Challenges | Resolving relative times, update detection, keeping the agent from guessing, voice latency |
| Accomplishments | The memory rules working live; the agent answering the same question consistently |
| What we learned | Designing an AI that knows what it doesn't know |
| What's next | Caregiver testing, agitation sensing with Presage, multilingual support |
| Built with | ElevenLabs, Gemini, Tiger Data, Snowflake, GoDaddy Registry, React, FastAPI, Postgres |

### Video plan (record Saturday by 9 PM)

1. 15 seconds: the problem, with text on screen
2. 75 seconds: the demo core steps plus the family message
3. 20 seconds: the architecture, naming each sponsor tool
4. 10 seconds: team and links

## Risks and fallbacks

Every risk below has a fallback that keeps the demo alive. Decide the trigger in advance so nobody debates it at 3 AM.

| Risk | Warning sign | Fallback |
|---|---|---|
| Voice cloning not on our ElevenLabs plan | Clone fails Friday | MLH credits; otherwise a stock voice labeled "Anna (sample voice)" |

| Risk | Warning sign | Fallback |
|---|---|---|
| Agent answers slowly or talks over people | More than 3 seconds per answer | Shorter prompt, fewer tool calls, push to talk instead of open mic |
| Agent guesses instead of using tools | Answers without a tool call in testing | Stricter prompt; make get_memories return "none" explicitly; lower the model temperature |
| Extraction gets times wrong | Fails the test set | Pass the current datetime and timezone; few-shot examples; the caregiver edits before confirming |
| Update detection misses ("change pickup to two") | New memory created instead of a supersede | Send current memories with the transcript; add a manual "this replaces" picker on the card |
| Snowflake setup eats hours | Not working by Saturday 3 PM | Drop the life story search; still 5 tracks |
| Dining hall is too loud | The mic hears neighbors | Headset mic, push to talk, typed fallback on the patient page |
| Venue Wi-Fi drops | APIs time out | Phone hotspot; backup video ready |
| Someone gets sick or burns out | Missed checkpoint | Each lane has a backup person: Voice and Interface cover each other, Memory documents endpoints clearly |
| Demo state gets messy between judges | Old memories on screen | Reset button after every judge |

## Hard rules

- No new features after Saturday 6 PM on the demo path.
- No code pushed after 12 PM Sunday.

- No real patient data, ever. Rose and Anna are fictional, and the only cloned voice is a consenting teammate's.